

Cumulative Final Paper

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Introduction

This paper examines the field of technical writing and how its principles apply across modern disciplines. Additionally, its importance in professional communication is highlighted.

Furthermore, this analysis presents the relevance of technical writing through its objectives, mechanics, and applications while showcasing its history to better understand its role in contemporary professional communication.

Research indicates that technical writing is essential to a multitude of industries. Its ability to communicate subjects to distinct types of audiences in an objective manner is invaluable to most disciplines.

Technical Writing first gained prominence with Geoffrey Chaucer (1343-1400), who authored a treatise on the astrolabe, an ancient tool used to measure altitude, latitude, and time of astronomical bodies. This treatise explains the intricate details of the astrolabe in plain English. Scientists today write similar works, such as academic journals, to document their findings in a concise manner for both general and professional audiences. Therefore, Chaucer was one of, if not the first, English technical writers (Basquin, 1981). Later, in World War II, technical writing developed further with memos. German forces used memos to send messages with simplicity and

efficiency, as they needed a way for soldiers to communicate quickly and clearly in battle.

Memos remain common tools for technical writers today for similar reasons (Dyrud, 2001).

These historical events have shaped the modern form of technical writing. From user manuals to email memos, this field plays a significant role in how professionals deliver complex content in a wide range of industries. For this reason, it is important for readers to understand the basis of the documents they rely on for essential data within their respective disciplines.

Study

Historically, Chaucer and the Germans created documents that were simple and conveyed intricate details quickly and concisely. Documents like scholarly articles condense and present results from larger research studies or experiments, which resembles how treatises worked.

Memos, typically used in business emails, provide only useful details in the shortest possible plain language word count. German forces implemented them the exact same way to communicate in high-stress warfare.

These developments have shaped the core principles of technical writing, which revolve around communicating ideas quickly and efficiently. The 5 C's are a perfect example of this central idea, as they create a set of prioritizations for technical writers. The first of the 5 C's, clear, emphasizes writing with utmost clarity. The second of the 5 C's, concise, emphasizes writing in brief, basic clauses. The third of the 5 C's, consistent, emphasizes writing with consistency in diction, tone, voice, and structure. The fourth of the 5 C's, complete, emphasizes including only the most necessary information in writing. The fifth and final C, correct, emphasizes including objective, valid information in writing through understandable, proper grammar (Folk, 2025).

Additionally, technical writers often accompany their content with visual aids. Images and videos help with capturing the engagement of an audience and maintaining it. They also increase the likelihood of readers understanding the content they are consuming (Last, S., McCurrey, D., Hagstrom-Schmidt, N., et al.). Thus, technical writing embodies the essence of communicating concepts to a variety of audiences in the most understandable way possible.

Individuals capable of applying this practice are needed across most disciplines. Shareholders, colleagues, students, consumers, and many others may need to know specific reports, so someone must be able to express them accurately and coherently. Scientific fields require scholarly journals to contribute their work to a certain discipline, and businesses depend on memos to professionally disclose company relevant details to their personnel. Technology companies may call for grants to receive necessary resources, which means someone must have the ability to write proper grant requests.

However, like most writing fields, technical writing has been impacted by gen AI (generative AI). Even so, it has not been rendered obsolete. Gen AI has difficulty consistently adopting the 5 C's and any type of visual aids into the content it generates. It is fundamentally sufficient at writing, but it lacks purpose and cognizance. Consequently, the content it generates might be lifeless, inaccurate, or misleading. AI-generated content also risks raising plagiarism concerns, as it does not belong to the person who requested it. In response, those in technical writing have limited gen AI's use to a certain extent (S, 2025 & Cozza, 2020). Therefore, technical writers are pivotal to the success of diverse disciplines despite generative AI's overwhelming impacts on writing fields.

Conclusion

As studies show, technical writing is crucial to a vast array of industries by precisely and objectively presenting concepts to audiences ranging from novices to professionals. Moreover, results from these studies provide two recommendations regarding generative AI tools in this field. Although technical writing methods are effective, they can be inflexible and difficult to integrate with AI. First, when technical writers do utilize AI, they should not have it write documents for them; instead, it should serve as an assistive tool in their work. Second, to stay relevant in their field, technical writers should develop a skill set that includes proficiency in generative AI tools.

Numerous writers of professional documents, such as memos and user manuals, rely on technical writing because it effectively conveys concepts with clarity and objectivity. Thus, it serves as the foundation for these documents, and it is essential that readers recognize its role in structuring the material they receive.

Judging by past and current patterns, it is possible that technical writing will continue to adopt generative AI, and, to avoid becoming irrelevant, writers will need to become comfortable with its employment. As a result, this industry may transition to emphasizing editing and refining written communication rather than creating it.

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